

Liam C Pendleton, MSc
Conservation Biologist
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Personal Objective

Conservation and communications professional with a background in coastal and avian ecological research and hands-on nonprofit program support. I combine scientific literacy and data skills with experience in community engagement, conservation advocacy, and multi-channel communications. I am skilled at making complex environmental topics accessible to broad audiences, from volunteers and members to agency and academic partners. I am seeking to grow into a conservation program leadership role that integrates habitat restoration, community engagement, and organizational communications.

Skills

Conservation Advocacy | Community Engagement | Habitat Restoration | Environmental Monitoring | Field Surveys | Plant ID | R
GitHub Project Management | Social Media Management | Newsletter & Content Editing | Marketing Communications | Technical
Writing | Excel | Public Speaking | Team Supervision | Cross-Sector Collaboration | Database Management | Data Analysis

Professional Experience

Washington Native Plant Society Seattle, WA
Conservation & Marketing Program Specialist 01/2026 - Present
Serve a dual role supporting the marketing and communications functions of a statewide native plant nonprofit while providing research and advocacy support to the organization's Conservation Committee.

- Manage social media content and strategy across platforms, developing and scheduling posts that translate conservation and botanical topics for general public and member audiences
- Co-edit and contribute content to the monthly member newsletter, coordinating across staff and regional chapters to support organizational communications
- Support website content updates in partnership with the Executive Director, maintaining accuracy and relevance of public-facing materials
- Develop conservation information briefs synthesizing research on active policy and land-use issues, providing the Conservation and Executive Committees with accessible, centralized references for forming and communicating organizational positions
- Draft member-facing conservation communications and calls to action, translating complex regulatory and ecological issues into accessible messaging for a non-specialist audience
- Developing a conservation activity tracking system and supporting the build-out of centralized committee workflows and communication infrastructure

Washington Native Plant Society Seattle, WA
Administrative Assistant 07/2025 – 12/2025
Served as the primary point of contact for a statewide native plant nonprofit, supporting membership services, office operations, and organizational communications.

- Served as first point of contact for member and public inquiries, providing customer service across phone, email, and in-person interactions
- Managed membership records and communications using database systems, maintaining data integrity and supporting membership retention
- Supported chapter volunteers and regional groups with communications, scheduling, and resources
- Maintained and updated website content, photo libraries, and digital materials
- Assisted with financial record-keeping, banking tasks, and expense tracking in support of the Executive Director
- Provided general administrative support across office operations, including mail, records management, and coordination of staff resources

Washington Cooperative Fish and Wildlife Research Unit

Seattle, WA

Research Assistant

07/2021 - 06/2024

Collaborated with state, federal and community science partners to design and lead a long-term seabird monitoring program for nesting seabird populations at Protection Island National Wildlife Refuge, WA, which is a federally protected site supporting ESA-listed species.

- Led field operations at a remote island site, managing logistics, equipment, crew scheduling, and safety protocols across 20+ field days per season
- Trained and supervised field crew in data collection and ESA-compliant protocols in proximity to protected wildlife
- Applied statistical modeling, machine learning, and GIS-based spatial analysis to assess seabird reproductive success and foraging habitat, contributing to long-term population monitoring datasets
- Authored technical reports, permit applications, funding proposals, and data collection protocols in support of ongoing conservation research
- Communicated research findings to audiences of varying expertise, from scientific partners to community members, through presentations and outreach events

Bird Laboratory, Eastern Michigan University

Ypsilanti, MI

Research Assistant

08/2019 - 05/2021

Led spatial analysis of habitat use by a protected songbird species using movement modeling and GIS to identify core habitat and inform conservation priorities across 5,000+ hectares of coniferous, montane habitat.

- Managed and quality-controlled a large-scale spatial dataset tracking habitat use across 5,000+ hectares, ensuring data integrity for long-term conservation research
- Applied spatial modeling techniques in R to map habitat use patterns and define priority conservation areas for a protected songbird species
- Led logistical planning for a multi-week field data collection trip in the US Pacific Northwest, coordinating travel, equipment, and scheduling for the research team
- Collected field data contributing approximately 20% additional data points to existing long-term monitoring datasets

Aquatic Geochemistry Laboratory, University of Michigan

Ann Arbor, MI

Data Analyst

02/2020 - 09/2020

Analyzed environmental data from Alaskan Arctic permafrost samples to identify key drivers of methane production, contributing to climate-relevant ecological research.

- Assessed variation across 15+ chemical properties in 50+ permafrost samples using Excel, identifying significant environmental contributors to greenhouse gas production
- Delivered weekly analytical summaries to the principal investigator, improving project workflow and efficiency of ongoing lab research

Bird Center of Washtenaw County

Ann Arbor, MI

Supervisor

05/2017- 11/2019

Oversaw daily operations of a wildlife rehabilitation nonprofit, managing staff, volunteers, data systems, and community partnerships to support animal care and organizational growth.

- Hired, supervised, and trained 20+ interns and volunteers; developed training materials and provided ongoing professional development
- Coordinated annual fundraising and community outreach events, securing \$30,000+ in donations annually
- Collaborated with board members and external partners to develop partnership supporting organizational growth and community engagement
- Managed a database of 3,000+ patient records, overseeing data integrity, entry, and reporting processes
- Developed and managed operational event budgets, including expense forecasting, cost tracking, and equipment procurement
- Assisted in authoring and editing annual reports analyzing clinic statistics, seasonal intake trends, rehabilitation success rates, and species data

Detroit Audubon Society

Detroit, MI

Conservation Technician

05/2018 - 08/2019

- Monitored 30+ shorebird nests across multiple sites, tracking and reporting nest success and environmental conditions to inform conservation management
- Conducted habitat and vegetation surveys and recorded water quality data at active study sites
- Assisted in restoring 3 acres of native prairie habitat, improving habitat quality for native bird and pollinator species
- Engaged with community members to promote local, backyard conservation practices and awareness of native wildlife

Education

University of Washington | 2024

M.S., Aquatic and Fishery Sciences

Eastern Michigan University | 2021

B.S., Biology

Washtenaw Community College | 2018

A.A., Liberal Arts

Volunteering

Birds Connect Seattle

Seattle, WA

Conservation Committee Member

03/2026 – Present

- Serve on the Conservation Committee of a leading regional bird conservation nonprofit, contributing to policy research and advocacy position development
- Currently developing the organization's position statement on outdoor cats and their impact on native bird populations

Pacific Seabird Group

Seattle, WA

Organizer

11/2023 - 03/2024

- Designed and facilitated a professional development panel for early career conservation professionals, coordinating panelists from diverse professional backgrounds
- Assisted in organizing a professional mentoring event, pairing mentors with student mentees across conservation-related fields

Salish Sea Guillemot Network

Seattle, WA

Field Technician

05/2022 - 08/2023

- Monitored foraging activity and prey provisioning of pigeon guillemots at multiple sites across Puget Sound in support of long-term population monitoring efforts

Ann Arbor Natural Area Preservation

Ann Arbor, MI

Field Technician

05/2019 - 08/2020

- Conducted bird surveys and vegetation assessments at 10+ sites to evaluate songbird diversity and abundance following habitat restoration initiatives